

AIM

DO.020 DOCUMENTATION STANDARDS AND PROCEDURES

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Introduction

The Documentation Standards and Procedures deliverable provides a checklist of standards and procedures to use when writing project-specific documentation.

The document covers the following topics:

- paragraph and sentence structure
- usage
- user input and system output
- lists
- notes, cautions, and warnings
- numbers and operations
- translation and international audiences
- preferred terms
- initial material
- writing and editing
- translation procedures
- downloading
- testing and change control
- hard copy and reproduction
- backups and archives

Who Should Read This Document

Readers of this document include:

- Technical writers and trainers use the Documentation Standards when producing project-specific documentation.
- Project staff members use the Documentation Standards and Procedures when reviewing project-specific documentation for consistency.

Paragraph and Sentence Structure

Paragraph Structure

Paragraph Guidelines

Use the following guidelines for paragraph structure:

- Write short paragraphs where each paragraph expresses a single idea. For example, if you write a ten-sentence paragraph that contains three distinct ideas, break it into three shorter paragraphs.
- Begin each paragraph with a topic sentence that either states the paragraph's idea or describes the information contained in it.
- Use subheadings to indicate natural breaks in topics. Subheadings indicate logical groupings of information under a main topic. They may help define a sequence of events or highlight different aspects of the main topic.

Sentence Structure

Sentence Guidelines

Use the following guidelines for sentence structure:

- Use the active voice. It is effective in writing user and course documentation, particularly for procedural information.
- Do not use the passive voice when writing procedural information. Passive voice is more difficult to understand.

Simple and Logical Sentence Structures

Choose sentence structures that organize your ideas simply and logically. Use shorter sentences for clarity. For example:

Right Use this screen to register claims.

Wrong If you want to register claims, use this screen.

Punctuation

This section discusses punctuation guidelines:

- Commas
- Colons
- Semicolons
- Quotation Marks
- Ellipses
- Dashes
- Hyphens
- Apostrophes

Commas

Separation of a Series of Three or More Elements

Separate a series of three or more elements. Where a conjunction joins the last two elements, precede the conjunction with a comma.

Example:

Right For most invoices, you enter only vendor, invoice number, date, and amount.

Separation of Ideas or Clauses

Separate ideas or clauses to make your sentence easier to read and unambiguous. Examples:

Right If you enter an application status incorrectly, you can only correct it by deleting the record and replacing it with a new record.

Wrong If you enter an application status incorrectly you can only correct it by deleting the record and replacing it with a new record.

Colons

Lists

Use a colon to introduce a list.

Examples:

Right	When you select this item from the menu, Application Foundation displays three fields: Tool, Username, and Password.
Wrong	When you select this item from the menu, Application Foundation displays three fields; Tool, Username, and Password.

Semicolons

Avoid or use semicolons sparingly, as they are confusing to non-native English speakers.

Quotation Marks

Use of Quotation Marks

Minimize the use of quotation marks. Do not use quotation marks for emphasis. Single quotes are suitable only for quotations within quotations. Choose straight quotes rather than smart quotes, as straight quotes minimizes translation costs considerably.

Punctuation with Quotation Marks

Place closing punctuation *inside* a closing quotation mark when you are quoting complete sentences.

Examples:

Right	David Miller, President of Ace Software Inc., said, "We have over 100 general ledger packages in use around the world."
Wrong	David Miller, President of Ace Software Inc., said, "We have over 100 general ledger packages in use around the world".

If you are putting quotation marks around a term, for example when quoting computer input or output, put punctuation *outside* the quotation marks, *unless* the punctuation is part of the input or output.

Examples

Right	If you define a period called "January", enter 01-JAN-1999 for the start date.
Wrong	If you define a period called "January," enter 01-JAN-1999 for the start date.

Ellipses

Indicate an omission in the text with an ellipsis. Type three full stops, without spaces, to produce an ellipsis.

Examples:

Right	Calls to Application Foundation do not include semicolons, but SQL*Forms calls, such as #EXEMACRO..., must include a semicolon.
Wrong	Calls to Application Foundation do not include semicolons, but SQL*Forms calls, such as #EXEMACRO. . ., must include a semicolon.

Dashes

There are three reasons to limit your use of dashes:

- Some automatically generated HTML files may not preserve the distinction between different hyphens, en dashes, and em dashes.
- Web browsers may not be able to interpret or display en and em dashes.
- Dashes are not easily translatable to other languages.

Different Types of Dashes

There are three different types of dashes:

- **En dash**

Use an en dash (–) in place of *to* for continuing or inclusive terms to indicate a range of numbers and dates. When you use a dash in place of *to*, do not precede or follow it with spaces.

Examples:

Right May-June 1999

Wrong May - June 1999

- **Em dash (double dash)**

Use the longer em dash (—) in place of *that is*. An em dash sets off a break in thought or to set off a defining phrase or summary. Leave no spaces before and after an em dash.

Examples:

Right Oracle General Ledger runs on any computer — mainframe, minicomputer, and PC — because it uses Oracle.

Wrong Oracle General Ledger runs on any computer — mainframe, minicomputer, and PC — because it uses Oracle.

Wrong Oracle General Ledger runs on any computer-- mainframe, minicomputer, and PC -- because it uses Oracle.

- **Half en dash** - Use this small dash between screen name and number.

Example:

Matching a Rule Definition - HAT031

Hyphens

Correct Usage

Use a hyphen if:

- Two or more words form a compound adjective such as, *newly-defined account*, *pop-up menu*, *user-defined function*, and *fourth-generation language*.
- The root word of a compound adjective begins with a capital letter, such as *non-SQL variable*.
- The addition of a prefix creates a double vowel such as, *re-execute*.
- The omission of the hyphen confuses meaning, such as with homographs (words that have the same spelling but different meanings): *re-form* (to form again) and *reform* (a correction of what is defective or wrong).
- You are using a series of words to modify a noun, such as *easy-to-use system*, *step-by-step instructions*, *day-to-day running*, and *up-to-date equipment*. Note, that if the phrase follows the noun it modifies, omit the hyphens such as in the phrase *the equipment is up to date*.

Incorrect Usage

These prefixes often form solid words even when they serve as adjectives, such as *hypersensitive*, *infrared*, and *nonadaptive*. Do not use a hyphen if the following prefixes, together with their root words, form parts of speech other than adjectives.

anti-	infra-	non-	semi-
co-	intra-	pre-	sub-
de-	macro-	pseudo-	supra-
hyper-	micro-	re-	un-
hypo-			

Apostrophes

An apostrophe s ('s) indicates possession. For example, *the user's eye* means *the eye of the user*. Be careful not to put an apostrophe to indicate a plural. Use the plural possessive carefully, for example *men's*, *farmers'*.

Be careful, also when using *its*. *It's* is the contracted form of *it is*. *Its* means belonging to it.

Examples:

Right The chapter is divided into subsections. Its main subsections are listed below.

Wrong The chapter is divided into subsections. It's main subsections are listed below.

Usage

This section discusses standards for language usage in technical documentation:

- Style
- Capitalization
- Italics
- Abbreviations

Style

American English or British English

Use American English or British English throughout your document, depending on your market audience. Be consistent.

Spell words exactly as they appear on the screen you are quoting. Remember to use your spell checker to assist in correct spelling.

Using Emphasis

Use the format verb-noun-adverb when you want to stress the importance of an instruction. Your reader remembers the last word of the sentence.

Examples:

Right	Notify your requester immediately.
Wrong	Immediately notify your requester.
Right	If your project is over budget, get approval for additional funds promptly.
Wrong	If your project is over budget, promptly get approval for additional funds.

You can use italics to emphasize a word or phrase in the main body of the text but use this sparingly. Use a *Note*, *Caution*, or *Warning* icon if you want to draw your attention to a paragraph of information.

Second Person

When writing course or user documentation, address the user in the second person (*you*). Do not use the first person (*I*, *we*) or gender words (*he*, *she*, *his*, and *her*). Using the second person helps to avoid awkward gender pronouns.

Examples:

Right	Use this screen to issue books.
Wrong	We use this screen to issue books.
Wrong	The user can use this screen to enter books.
Right	Once you have an account, you can customize the system parameters.

Wrong After a user gets an account, he can customize the system parameters.

Superfluous Information

Do not include any more words than is necessary. Avoid tautologies such as:

- acute crisis
- adequate enough
- connect together
- important essentials
- equally as
- serious danger
- vital necessity

Avoid verbose phrases such as:

- due to the fact
- for the purpose of
- needless to say
- and so as a result

Avoiding the Passive Voice

You can identify the passive voice by looking for the following signs:

- Subject receives the action: The invoice form is chosen by you.
- Verbs that end in -ed: Invoices are handled by Oracle Libraries.

Examples:

Right Set up daily fine rates for your organization.

Wrong Daily fine rates are set up for your organization.

Right Set the flag to Y to change the status of the items.

Wrong This flag, when set to Y for a particular status, may be used to change the status of the items.

Using the Present Tense

Keep your reading immediate. Avoid past or future tenses, unless you refer specifically to a past or future event or date. Do not use the words *will* or *shall* unless you refer to a specific or future event.

Examples:

Right Select books from the list of media.

Wrong You will select books from the list of media.

Right If you do not catalogue individual issues in the Main Details screen, you cannot order serials.

Wrong If you did not catalogue individual issues in the Main

details screen, you cannot order serials.

Action Verbs

Use verbs that clearly describe an action or behavior.

Examples:

Right	Oracle Purchasing <i>collects</i> statistics on critical vendor performance.
Wrong	Oracle Purchasing <i>has</i> statistics on critical vendor performance.

Can and May

Can and *may* both mean permission. Use *can* for capability and *may* for possibility.

Examples:

Right	You can customize Oracle Housing to reflect your organization's policies and procedures. (permission)
Wrong	You may customize Oracle Housing to reflect your organization's policies and procedures.
Right	You may lose data if your rollback segments are too small. (possibility)
Wrong	You can lose data if your rollback segments are too small.

Using That

Use *that* instead of *which* to introduce a restrictive clause. A restricted clause is essential to the meaning of the sentence. Do not precede *that* with a comma.

Examples:

Right	A menu path is a sequence of menu choices that you select to navigate a screen.
Wrong	A menu path is a sequence of menu choices which you select to navigate a screen.

Using Which

Use *which* to introduce a non-restrictive clause. You can spot a non-restrictive clause because it contains supplementary information which is not essential to a sentence. Precede *which* with a comma.

Examples:

Right	You can cancel a claim using the Cancel Claim screen, which is quicker than waiting for the claim to expire.
Wrong	You can cancel a claim using the Cancel Claim screen, that is quicker than waiting for the claim to expire.

Avoiding Gender Pronouns

If you do not need to use a third person pronoun, try to make your subject plural so that you can use *they* correctly. If you cannot avoid using the third person singular pronoun use *he/she* or *they*.

Examples:

Right	After users get an account, they can customize the system parameters.
Right	After a user gets an account, he/she can customize the system parameters.
Right (Best Option)	After getting an account, a user can customize the system parameters.
Wrong	After a user gets an account, he can customize the user parameters.

Capitalization

Headings

Capitalize book titles, chapter titles, figure captions, table captions, and section heads. Capitalize the following in headings:

- first and last words
- nouns
- pronouns
- adjectives
- adverbs
- proper names

Examples:

Right	Special Terms with Initial Capitals
Right	Sections within a Manual
Wrong	Special Terms With Initial Capitals

Do not capitalize articles and conjunctions (for example, *the* or *and*) unless they form the beginning of the heading.

Do not capitalize prepositions unless they form part of a verb:

Right	Setting Up Financial Information
Wrong	Setting up Financial Information

Proper Names

- personal names
- personal titles
- names of places

- languages and nationalities
- names of days, months, and religious festivals but not the names of seasons
- names of specific government departments, institutions, and organizations

Special Terms

Use initial capitals with the following terms:

Term	Example
Specific menu names	<i>The Print menu</i> (<i>menu</i> is lowercase)
Specific menu options	<i>The Paste option</i> (<i>option</i> is lowercase)
Mode names	<i>Query mode</i> (<i>mode</i> is lowercase)
Window names	<i>The Mail window</i> (<i>window</i> is lowercase)
Screen names	<i>The Maintain Skill Types screen</i> (<i>screen</i> is lowercase)
Block names	<i>The Skill Requirements block</i> (<i>block</i> is in lowercase)

Note: When referring to any of the above, capitalization should always follow what appears on the screen.

The following terms are generally all uppercase:

Term	Example
File names	OMDT.DOC
UNIX file names are case-sensitive. Write them exactly as they appear on the screen.	
Names of keys	CTRL, SHIFT
Statement names	DELETE, INSERT, and UPDATE
Reserved words	IF, MODE, and UNIQUE
Datatypes	CHAR, DATE
Logical operators	AND, OR, and NOT

Write function key names (for example, Enter, Return, and Esc) with initial capitals and place them within square brackets. For example:

Press [Commit] to ...

Italics

Key Words

Italicize a key word the first time it appears in your document. Include key words in the glossary.

Examples:

Right You can define a *work period* for a specific staff member in terms of a start and end date, and then create named *work units*. Each work unit occupies a defined fraction

of the work period.

Wrong You can define a “work period” for a specific staff member in terms of a start and end date, and then create named “work units”. Each “work unit” occupies a defined fraction of the “work period”.

Book, Chapter and Section Names

If you refer to a book, chapter, or section in your document, put the title in italics.

Examples:

Right For more information about documentation components, refer to Chapter 4, *Guidelines for Producing Different Documentation Types*.

Right For more information about defining staff skills, see the *Overview* section of this chapter.

Abbreviations

Spell words in full. Abbreviations slow your reader down, and they are ambiguous.

Latin Abbreviations

Not all readers understand Latin abbreviations, and some international audiences do not use them at all.

- Use *and so on* instead of *etc.* or *etcetera*.
- Use *for example* and *for instance* instead of e.g.
- Use *that is* or *in other words* rather than i.e.

Acronyms

Correct Usage

Your reader may not know what an acronym means. If you must use one, spell the complete term in full with the acronym in parentheses the first time you use the term. Use an acronym if any of the following points apply:

- The full name is very long.
- Industry journals frequently use the acronym.
- Industry professionals frequently use the acronym.
- The term is more commonly known by the acronym rather than the fully spelled term. Examples of this situation are *radio* or *HTML*.

Examples:

Right Oracle Housing is a computerized housing management database application using the Oracle Relational Database Management System (RDBMS).

Wrong Oracle Housing is a computerized housing management database application using the Oracle

Relational Database Management System.

Wrong Oracle Housing is a computerized housing management database application using the Oracle RDBMS.

Plural Acronyms

To make the plural of an acronym:

- If you spelled with capital letters append an *s*, for example, VARs (no apostrophe).
- If you spelled the acronym with lower case letters, use an apostrophe *s* in the plural, for example, *p's* and *q's*.

Contractions

Do not use contractions. Spell out words such as, *it's* (it is), *don't*, *can't*, *you've* and so on.

Examples:

Right Do not enter issues in this field.

Wrong Don't enter issues in this field.

User Input and System Output

This section provides guidelines for user input and system output references:

- User Input
- System Output

User Input

Use the bold Courier font to show text that your reader must enter.

Example:

Enter an **RE** (Registration) or **AT** (Attendance) category progress type in the progress type field.

System Output

Use the Courier font to show text displayed on the screen.

Example:

ACME Accounting displays the following message: PROVISIONAL or
CONFIRMED.

Lists

Lists:

- Simplify complex material.
- Indicate sequential steps.
- Compress repetitive wording.
- Provide a checklist.

This section discusses lists:

- Using Lists
- Punctuating Bulleted Lists
- Sequential Steps
- Defining Terms

Using Lists

Follow these rules for all lists:

- Provide a transitional sentence to introduce a list and finish the sentence with a colon (:).
- Include at least two list items.
- Use parallel construction for all items in the same list.

Punctuating Bulleted Lists

If a bullet item is a complete sentence, capitalize the first word and end with a full stop.

Example:

Before you use this form to define Zoom:

- Define Zoom, Destination, and Source applications.
- Register Zoom, Destination, and Source forms, blocks, and fields.

If bullet items are terms or phrases, do not capitalize the first word, and do not end with a full stop.

Example:

Topics included in this unit include:

- creating default groups from queries
- creating your own group
- structuring your data in a group hierarchy

Sequential Steps

Numbered lists almost always comprise sentences and, therefore, should have a capital letter to start and a full stop to finish.

Example:

To create a group, follow these steps:

1. Click and hold on a database column in an existing group.
2. Drag the column to an open area in the Data Model painter and release.
3. Replace the group name with a brief, but more meaningful one than the default.
4. Fill in the rest of the settings as appropriate.
5. Accept the property sheet.

Defining Terms

Use term and text lists in two-column format to define single terms or short phrases.

Example:

Ledger Report	A ledger report is a report that lists all journal entry transactions and the resulting balance from each transaction. You can specify Accounting Flexfield and accounting period ranges.
----------------------	---

When using terms in a list:

- Do not insert punctuation after a term.
- Capitalize each word, or show the term exactly as it appears on the form.

When using text definitions in a list:

- Capitalize the first word in the definition.
- Use parallel construction.
- End each definition with a full stop.

Attention, Suggestions, and Warning Icons

Do not use notes, cautions, or warnings too frequently as this reduces their impact. Use the following guidelines for notes, cautions, and warnings:

- Attention Icon
- Suggestion Icon
- Warning Icon

Attention Icon

Use an attention icon if you want to draw your reader's attention to something.

Example:



Attention: Once you have reserved resources for a meeting, you cannot delete the meeting details unless you first release resources.

Suggestion Icon

Insert the suggestion icon when you want to make a suggestion about a particular item.

Example:



Suggestion: Because this parameter is optional in Maintain Committee Details - HSTA3023, using it to select committees may not select all the committees you expect.

Warning Icon

Use a warning icon to identify issues that could have fatal results.

Example:



Warning: If you change an employee grade after running the spinal increment utility, then you lose the ability to perform a rollback.

Numbers and Operations

Use the following guidelines for numbers and operations:

- Guidelines for Numbers
- Guidelines for Operators
- Keys

Guidelines for Numbers

Correct Usage

Spell out:

- numbers from one to ten
- ordinal numbers, for example, first, second, third, and so on
- common fractions, for example, *two-thirds share*

Use:

- numerals for numbers above ten
- either all numerals or all spelled numbers for a list of numbers

Do not:

- end numbers with -ly, for example, *firstly, secondly, thirdly*, and so on
- use the word *number* when you identify a number in the text

Examples:

Right	You may define up to six additional fields.
Right	This screen has 11 blocks.
Right	A period consists of 9, 10, 11, or 12 consecutive months.
Wrong	A period consists of nine, ten, 11, or 12 consecutive months.

Correct Date Formats

Normally you use the DD-MON-YYYY format when you describe dates as you enter them or see them. Always use the hyphens to separate each group of numbers. Note that some applications differ as to the order of days, months, and years, but the use of the hyphens remains the same.

Right	For example, to tell Oracle Alert to stop sending messages at the end of the month, enter 31-JUL-1997.
Wrong	For example, to tell Oracle Alert to stop sending messages at the end of the month, enter JUL 31 1997.

Use full dates in documents that frequently change.

Examples:

Right April 27, 1997

Wrong 27 April, 1997

Use month and year for documents that rarely change, such as collateral materials or copyright pages. Do not insert punctuation between the month and year.

Examples:

Right April 1997

Wrong 04/97

Guidelines for Operators

Use mathematical operators within your text only when necessary:

+Addition

-Subtraction

*Multiplication

/Division

Keys

Function Names

If you mention function keys in text, enclose the text in square brackets, [] and do not mention the word *key* after the text. Use initial capitals for the text.

Examples:

- [Up]
- [Down]
- [Left]
- [Right]

Right Press [Exit] when you are ready to leave the system.

Wrong Press the [Quit] key when you are ready to leave the system.

Keyboard Activity -- Use the correct verbs for keyboard activity

- Press (not depress)
- Enter (not type)

Examples:

<i>Right</i>	Press [Exit] when you are ready to leave the system.
<i>Right</i>	Enter the name of the period you want to define.
Wrong	Type in the name of the period you want to define.

Translation and International Audiences

This section outlines the standards for writing for international audiences.

- Write accurately, clearly, and consistently.

Check your documentation carefully for ambiguous phrases and sentences.

- Avoid ambiguous word clusters.

Other languages do not necessarily have the same flexibility as the English language.

- Use consistent terminology.

Translators depend on terminology being consistent as they build up a glossary of translated terms and apply them throughout the text.

- Avoid jargon and figures of speech.

Jargon in one language may not have an equivalent in another language. Similarly, some figures of speech may not exist in every language.

- Choose examples carefully.

Avoid country-specific examples.

Avoid examples that may be offensive in another country.

Avoid referring to weights, measures and paper sizes in documentation used in the US and Europe. Weights and measures are imperial in the US and metric in Europe.

- Avoid text in any form in a diagram or illustration.

Design illustrations so that the text is outside the graphic itself or provide plenty of room inside the graphic for translation of the illustration.

- Do not repeat the product name.

- Documentation produced in the US has a tendency to repeat product names to make them more memorable. European cultures consider this both redundant and annoying. Vary your sentence structure so that you can avoid repetition of the product name.

Preferred Terms

The terms contained in the sections that follow are written exactly as they should appear in Oracle documentation as regards spelling and use of upper- and lowercase letters.

BE indicates where the British English spelling or usage is different.

Term	Comments and Examples
affect (noun)	<i>this parameter affects.....instead of this parameter effects</i>
affect (verb)	instead of <i>impact</i>
after image journal	instead of <i>After-Image journal</i>
amend	instead of <i>alter</i> or <i>change</i> in the context of correcting an error. Also see <i>change</i>
among	instead of <i>amongst</i>
analog (BE analogue)	instead of <i>analogue</i>
and so on	instead of <i>etc.</i>
appendices or appendixes	
application-wide (adjective)	
assembly language (noun)	
assembly-language (adjective)	
autologin	<i>automatic login to the Oracle RDBMS; one word when referring to Oracle usernames such as OPS\$DERRY</i>
back-dated	
back-pay	
backslash	
backspace	
backup (noun)	<i>carry out a daily backup</i>
back up (verb)	<i>to back up a file</i>
BASIC	
benchmark	
bitmap(ped)	
block mode (noun)	
block-mode (adjective)	<i>block-mode terminal</i>
boilerplate	
Boolean	
bootstrap	
bottom-up (adjective)	
braces	<i>{ }</i> not <i>curly brackets</i>
breakpoint	
busy	instead of <i>engaged</i> for telephone lines
bypass	
by-product	
by way of	instead of <i>via</i>
cannot	instead of <i>can not</i>
case-sensitive	
car rental	instead of <i>car hire</i>
categorize (BE categorise)	
centralize (BE centralise)	
change	use where the alteration is not required because of an error. For example: <i>change the values...</i>
center (BE centre)	
character-based (adjective)	
character mode (noun)	
character-mode (adjective)	
checkbox	
checklist	
checkpoint	

Term	Comments and Examples
checksum	
client-server	instead of <i>client/server</i>
clipboard	
code name	instead of <i>codename</i>
coexist	
connection	
context-sensitive (adjective)	<i>context-sensitive help</i>
cooperate	
coordinate (noun, verb)	
correlated	
cross-check (verb)	
cross-refer (verb)	
cross-reference (noun, verb)	
customize	
custom-made (adjective)	
data is	instead of <i>data are</i>
database	
data dictionary	
dataflow	
datastore	
datatype	
deadlock	
decentralize (BE decentralise)	
dependent (adjective)	
description	
desktop	
different from	instead of <i>different than</i> or <i>different to</i>
disk	instead of <i>disc</i>
disk drive	
disk space	
dispatch	
display-only (adjective before noun)	<i>a display-only block</i>
double-sided	
download (verb)	<i>to download the files</i>
downsize (verb)	
DUAL table	
effect (noun)	<i>the effect of this command is...</i>
email	instead of <i>e-mail</i>
embed(ded)	instead of <i>imbed</i>
enable	instead of <i>allow</i> or <i>lets</i> ; for example, <i>Oracle Libraries enables you to calculate claims</i>
end user (noun)	<i>developed for end users</i>
end-user (adjective)	<i>an end-user command</i>
enter	instead of <i>input</i>
inquire (BE enquire)	
inquiry (BE enquiry)	
environment	instead of <i>system</i>
equi-join	
except for	instead of <i>save for</i>
extended SQL	
fast path (noun)	
fastpath (adjective)	
fast track (noun)	
fast-track (adjective)	
feedback	
file lockout	
filename	
file type	
first-cut	
first name	instead of <i>Christian name</i> or <i>given name</i>
floating-point (adjective)	
flowchart	

Term	Comments and Examples
focused	
focusing	
form-feed	
FORTRAN	
from...to...	instead of <i>through</i> to express a range, for example, <i>from page 1 to page 10 inclusive</i>
front-end (adjective)	
front-to-back button	
fuel	instead of <i>petrol</i> or <i>gas</i>
full-screen (adjective)	
function hierarchy diagram	
Function Hierarchy Diagrammer	
general-purpose (adjective)	
grab bar	two words to avoid the double consonant
graphics-based	
hand over (verb)	<i>to hand over the project</i>
handover (noun)	<i>to complete the project handover</i>
hands-on (adjective)	
hard copy (adjective)	
hardware	instead of <i>system</i> (although <i>operating system</i> is acceptable)
high-level (adjective)	
highlight (noun, verb)	
hitlist (adjective)	<i>hitlist table</i>
host id	
host name	
hypermedia	
hypertext	
idealize (BE idealise)	
in-depth (adjective)	
indices (BE indexes)	
industry-standard (adjective)	
in-house	
italicize (BE italicise)	
install, installment (BE install, instalment)	
itemize (BE itemise)	
keyword	
keystroke	
kilobyte (KB)	
layout	
leading-edge (adjective)	
left-hand	
left-justified	
license (noun) (BE licence)	
license (verb)	
life-cycle (noun)	except <i>Business System Life Cycle</i>
line-feed	
log in (verb)	use <i>log in</i> for starting, invoking or calling an application/program/software after <i>logging onto</i> the machine or operating system
login (adjective, noun)	for example, <i>login id</i> , <i>login time</i>
log off (verb)	leave the machine or operating system; the opposite of <i>log on</i>
log on (verb)	<i>please log on to the system</i>
logon (noun)	<i>each user has a database logon</i>
log out (verb)	leave an application/program/software; the opposite of <i>log in</i>
lockout	
look up (verb)	
look-up (noun, adjective)	
lowercase	
custom-made (BE made-to-order)	

Term	Comments and Examples
mailbox	
many-to-many	
many-to-one	
master detail	
media	treat as singular
megabyte (MB)	
meta-model	CASE Meta-model
microcomputer	
microprocessor	
minicomputer	
mouse-driven	
move to	instead of <i>enter</i> , <i>access</i> or <i>see</i> ; for example <i>move to the Housing Rents block</i>
off line (follows noun)	<i>The Printer Is Off Line.</i>
offline (adjective before noun)	<i>the offline printer</i>
off site (follows noun)	<i>the project team works off site</i>
offsite (adjective before noun)	<i>there is an offsite maintenance option</i>
onto	use <i>onto</i> except where <i>on</i> is part of a verb, for example, <i>please log on to the system</i>
on line (follows noun)	<i>the system is on line</i>
online (adjective before the noun)	<i>online editing</i>
parenthesis (plural: parentheses)	()--instead of brackets
part-time (adjective)	<i>a part-time lecturer</i>
path name	
PC	instead of <i>personal computer</i> or <i>pc</i>
plug in (verb)	
plug-in (adjective)	
pop up (verb)	
pop-up (adjective)	<i>a pop-up window pops up</i>
port-specific (adjective)	
position (verb)	instead of <i>with the cursor</i> , <i>move to the Code field...</i> ; for example, <i>position the cursor in the Code field and enter a query</i>
postal code	instead of <i>zip code</i> or <i>post code</i>
post-field (adjective)	
PostScript	
practice (noun)	
practice (verb)	
precompiler	
predefine	
pre-empt	
preload	
printout (noun)	
pseudo-code	
pseudo-column	
pull down (verb)	
pull-down (adjective)	
query-by-example	
query-only	<i>a query-only block</i>
quietpoint	
read-only	
realize (BE realise)	
realtime (adjective)	
re-engineer	
reentrant	
re-execute	
right-justified	
right-hand	
roll back (verb)	
rollback (adjective, noun)	
rowheader	
row-level	

Term	Comments and Examples
rubber band (noun)	
rubber-band (adjective)	GUI term
run through (verb)	
runthrough (noun)	
runtime	
savepoint	
screendump (noun)	
screen painting	
screenshot	
scrollbar	
self-join	
session-wide	
set up (verb)	
setup (noun, adjective)	
shared-disk system	that is, a system with a shared hard disk
shut down (verb)	<i>shut down the system</i>
shutdown (noun, adjective)	<i>a system shutdown, a shutdown routine</i>
sign off (verb)	
sign-off (noun, adjective)	
sign on (verb)	
sign-on (noun, adjective)	
similar to	instead of <i>similar with</i>
single-application (adjective)	<i>single-application mode</i>
single-sided	
single-user (adjective)	
snapshot	
softbox	
soft copy (adjective)	
software	instead of <i>system</i>
specify (verb)	instead of <i>detail</i>
a SQL (file/statement/and so on)	instead of <i>an SQL (file/statement/and so on)</i>
square brackets	
standalone (adjective)	<i>a standalone computer</i>
start up (verb)	
startup (noun, adjective)	
state-of-the-art (adjective)	
status	avoid using plural
step-by-step	
stock	instead of <i>inventory</i>
storyboard	
sub	Do not use a hyphen when using this prefix. The exceptions are listed here.
sub-entity	synonym for <i>sub-type</i>
sub-module	
sub-type	
super-module	
supersede	
super-type	
swap (BE swop)	
tablespace	
terabyte (TB)	
that is	instead of <i>i.e.</i>
throughput	
time scale	
timesharing	
timesheet	
time stamp	
toolbox	
tooldriver	
toolkit	
top-down (adjective)	
tree-structured (adjective)	

Term	Comments and Examples
troubleshoot(er)	
turnkey	
two-phase commit	
underscore	instead of <i>underline</i> or <i>underbar</i>
upload (verb)	
uppercase	
up-to-date (adjective)	
user-defined (adjective)	
user-friendly (adjective)	
user id	
user interface	
user name	
user-named triggers	
vacation	use <i>public holiday</i> to refer to national holidays
Vice-Chancellor	
Vice-Principal	
viewname	
visualize (BE visualise)	
warm start (verb)	
warmstart (noun, adjective)	
wildcard	
workaround	
workforce	
workgroup	
workstation	
wraparound	
x-axis	
y-axis	

Initial Material

User Reference Manual (DO.060)

Application Extensions Functional Design (MD.050)

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Source Document 2

User Guide (DO.070)

Current Process Model (BP.040)

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Business Procedure Documentation (BP.090)

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Application Setup Documents (BR.100)

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Source Document 4

Technical Reference Manual (DO.080)**Database Extensions Design (MD.060)**

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Application Extensions Technical Design (MD.070)

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Conversion Data Mapping (CV.040)

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Conversion Program Designs (CV.060)

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Source Document 6

System Management Guide (DO.090)

System Management Procedures (TA.150)

Source Document Name:

Source Document File Name:

Source Document Security:

Source Document Retrieval:

Source Document Owner:

Source Document Content:

Source Document 2

Writing and Editing

User Reference Manual (DO.060)

This section identifies the individuals assigned as writers, editors, and reviewers of the User Reference Manual (DO.060). It also outlines the procedures for use in editing and reviewing.

Assign Writers

Writer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Writing Assignment:

Writer 2 - Information

Assign Editors

Editor 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Editing Assignment:

Editor 2 - Information

Editing Process

Assign Reviewers

Reviewer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Review Assignment:

Reviewer 2 - Information

Review Process

Final Approval

Final Approver 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Final Approver 2 - Information

User Guide (DO.070)

This section identifies the individuals assigned as writers, editors, and reviewers of the User Guide (DO.070). It also outlines the procedures for use in editing and reviewing.

Assign Writers

Writer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Writing Assignment:

Writer 2 - Information

Assign Editors

Editor 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Editing Assignment:

Editor 2 - Information

Editing Process

Assign Reviewers

Reviewer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Review Assignment:

Reviewer 2 - Information

Review Process

Final Approval

Final Approver 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Final Approver 2 - Information

Technical Reference Manual (DO.080)

This section identifies the individuals assigned as writers, editors, and reviewers of the Technical Reference Manual (DO.080). It also outlines the procedures for use in editing and reviewing.

Assign Writers

Writer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Writing Assignment:

Writer 2 - Information

Assign Editors

Editor 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Editing Assignment:

Editor 2 - Information

Editing Process

Assign Reviewers

Reviewer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Review Assignment:

Reviewer 2 - Information

Review Process

Final Approval

Final Approver 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

*Final Approver 2 - Information***System Management Guide (DO.090)**

This document identifies the individuals assigned as writers, editors, and reviewers of the System Management Guide (DO.090). It also outlines the procedures for use in editing and reviewing.

Assign Writers

Writer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Writing Assignment:

*Writer 2 - Information***Assign Editors**

Editor 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Editing Assignment:

*Editor 2 - Information***Editing Process****Assign Reviewers**

Reviewer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Review Assignment:

Reviewer 2 - Information

Review Process

Final Approval

Final Approver 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Final Approver 2 - Information

Translation Procedures

Assign Translators

Translator 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Translation Assignment:

Translator 2 - Information

Assign Editors

Editor 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Editing Assignment:

Editor 2 - Information

Editing Process

Assign Reviewers

Reviewer 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Review Assignment:

Reviewer 2 - Information

Review Process

Final Approval

Final Approver 1 - Information

Name:

Location:

Telephone:

FAX:

Final Approver 2 - Information

Downloading

Use the following procedures for downloading documentation files to and from the documentation library:

User Reference Manual (DO.060)

User Guide (DO.070)

Technical Reference Manual (DO.080)

System Management Guide (DO.090)

Testing and Change Control

Testing

User Reference Manual Validation Procedure

User Guide Validation Procedure

Technical Reference Manual Validation Procedure

System Management Guide Validation Procedure

Change Control

- Procedures
- Software
- Architecture
- File Structure
- Naming Convention
- Philosophy

User Reference Manual (DO.060)

Source File Information

Source File Name:

Source File Type:

Source File Format:

Source System:

Source Owner:

Source Owner Telephone:

Source Owner Location:

Source Owner FAX:

Change Request Procedure

User Guide (DO.070)

Source File Information

Source File Name:

Source File Type:

Source File Format:

Source System:

Source Owner:

Source Owner Telephone:

Source Owner Location:

Source Owner FAX:

Change Request Procedure

Technical Reference Manual (DO.080)

Source File Information

Source File Name:

Source File Type:

Source File Format:

Source System:

Source Owner:

Source Owner Telephone:

Source Owner Location:

Source Owner FAX:

Change Request Procedure

System Management Guide (DO.090)

Source File Information

Source File Name:

Source File Type:

Source File Format:

Source File System:

Source Owner:

Source Owner Telephone:

Source Owner Location:

Source Owner FAX:

Change Request Procedures

Hard Copy and Reproduction

User Reference Manual (DO.060)

Source Document Information

Source document file name:

Source document file type:

Source document file format:

Hard copy and Reproduction Requirements

Number of hard copies:

Printer ID:

Storage 1 Information

Storage location:

Delivery method to storage:

Retrieval method from storage:

Storage 2 Information

Storage location:

Delivery method to storage:

Retrieval method from storage:

Shipping Method:

Recipient 1 Information:

Recipient Name:

Recipient Address:

Recipient 2 Information

Recipient Name:

Recipient Address:

User Guide (DO.070)

Source Document Information

Source document file name:

Source document file type:

Source document file format:

Hard copy and Reproduction Requirements

Number of hard copies:

Printer ID:

Storage 1 Information

Storage location:

Delivery method to storage:

Retrieval method from storage:

Storage 2 Information

Storage location:

Delivery method to storage:

Retrieval method from storage:

Shipping Method:

Recipient 1 Information:

Recipient Name:

Recipient Address:

Recipient 2 Information

Recipient Name:

Recipient Address:

Technical Reference Manual (DO.080)

Source Document Information

Source document file name:

Source document file type:

Source document file format:

Hard copy and Reproduction Requirements

Number of hard copies:

Printer ID:

Storage 1 Information

Storage location:

Delivery method to storage:

Retrieval method from storage:

Storage 2 Information

Storage location:

Delivery method to storage:

Retrieval method from storage:

Shipping Method:

Recipient 1 Information:

Recipient Name:

Recipient Address:

Recipient 2 Information

Recipient Name:

Recipient Address:

System Management Guide (DO.090)

Source Document Information

Source document file name:

Source document file type:

Source document file format:

Hard copy and Reproduction Requirements

Number of hard copies:

Printer ID:

Storage 1 Information

Storage location:

Delivery method to storage:

Retrieval method from storage:

Storage 2 Information

Storage location:

Delivery method to storage:

Retrieval method from storage:

Shipping Method:

Recipient 1 Information:

Recipient Name:

Recipient Address:

Recipient 2 Information

Recipient Name:

Recipient Address:

Backups and Archives

This section defines the backup and retrieval process for the documents produced during the Documentation process. It also includes the archival information.

User Reference Manual (DO.060)

Source File Information

Source File Name:

Source File Type:

Source File Format:

Backup Information

Frequency of Backups:

Backup Procedure Name:

Restore Procedure Name:

Storage Medium:

Storage Location:

Archive Information

Number of document versions to archive:

Storage Medium:

Storage Location:

Retrieval Method:

User Guide (DO.070)

Source File Information

Source File Name:

Source File Type:

Source File Format:

Backup Information

Frequency of Backups:

Backup Procedure Name:

Restore Procedure Name:

Storage Medium:

Storage Location:

Archive Information

Number of document versions to archive:

Storage Medium:

Storage Location:

Retrieval Method:

Technical Reference Manual (DO.080)

Source File Information

Source File Name:

Source File Type:

Source File Format:

Backup Information

Frequency of Backups:

Backup Procedure Name:

Restore Procedure Name:

Storage Medium:

Storage Location:

Archive Information

Number of document versions to archive:

Storage Medium:

Storage Location:

Retrieval Method:

System Management Guide (DO.090)

Source File Information

Source File Name:

Source File Type:

Source File Format:

Backup Information

Frequency of Backups:

Backup Procedure Name:

Restore Procedure Name:

Storage Medium:

Storage Location:

Archive Information

Number of document versions to archive:

Storage Medium:

Storage Location:

Review and Approval Process

The procedures for review and approval of documentation is as follows:

-
-
-

Documentation review and approval may occur at several stages during the implementation project. A separate review and approval may be required for:

- documentation requirements
- prototypes of deliverables
- draft versions of documents
- final versions of documents

Publication/Deployment

The organization will use the following methods for non-printed documentation deployment:

- portable electronic documents
- web pages

User Reference Manual (DO.060)

- Portable document format: Adobe Acrobat PDF
- Portable document file name:
- Portable document locations
- Web page URL:

User Guide (DO.070)

- Portable document format: Adobe Acrobat PDF
- Portable document file name:
- Portable document locations
- Web page URL:

Technical Reference Manual (DO.080)

- Portable document format: Adobe Acrobat PDF
- Portable document file name:
- Portable document locations
- Web page URL:

System Management Guide (DO.090)

- Portable document format: Adobe Acrobat PDF
- Portable document file name:
- Portable document locations
- Web page URL:

Open and Closed Issues for this Deliverable

Open Issues

ID	Issue	Resolution	Responsibility	Target Date	Impact Date

Closed Issues

ID	Issue	Resolution	Responsibility	Target Date	Impact Date